



Case Study Competition 2025

Roadmap for
India to win **100 medals**,
including **35 gold medals**,
at the

2036

Olympics

Team Changemakers

North East Zone

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Position India as a global sporting powerhouse by achieving 100 Olympic medals, including 35 golds, by 2036. This goal aligns with India's broader aspirations for holistic national development, fostering a culture of excellence, national pride, and international prestige

Approach



Understanding the Current Landscape – Identified weak and strong points of the Indian Sports System

Benchmarking Global Models – Studied China, UK, and Australia's sports ecosystems to understand how to drive success.

Data-Driven & Scalable Solutions – ensuring impact at both grassroots and elite levels.

Sustainability & Execution – Proposed an end to end implementation roadmap

Recommendations



Changing Mindsets
PE as a core subject, awareness campaigns, expanded competitions, & athlete mentorship

Talent Acquisition
Khel Connect for AI scouting, elite coaching expansion, structured athlete support, and performance tracking.

Governance & Legislation
Regulatory reforms, AI-driven governance, and a Sports Ombudsman for Transparency programs.

Infrastructure
Tiered development (Metro, Urban, Rural), smart facilities, PPP funding, and school sports upgrades.

Implementation & Budget Outlay Required



Proposed a **phased execution plan** focusing on our recommendations to ensure a **structured pathway from recreational play to elite sports** over five years.

Budget Outlay – A **₹38,750 Cr (~\$4.63B)** investment across infrastructure, talent acquisition, competitions, governance, and technology, aligning with global benchmarks to make India a **sports powerhouse by 2036**.

PRESENT LANDSCAPE OF SPORTS SECTOR IN INDIA

Education & Training

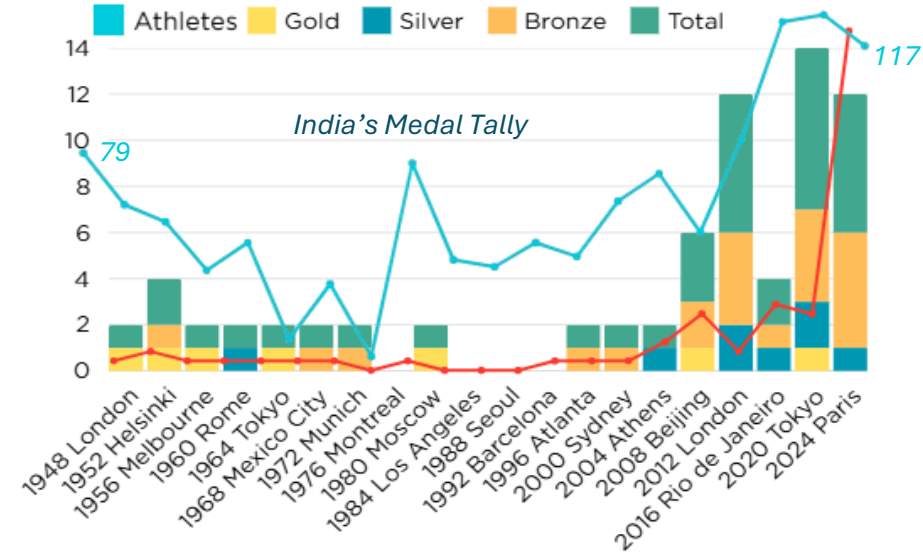
- **Khelo India Initiative:** 1,000+ centres established, supports grassroots athletes.
- **National Sports Policy 2024:** Focus on inclusivity, governance, and mass participation.
- **Coaching & Infrastructure:** 32 Khelo India State Centres of Excellence.

Performance Highlights

- **Olympics:** 41 total medals; Tokyo 2020 (7 medals), Paris 2024 (6 medals).
- **Key athletes:** Neeraj Chopra (Gold), Manu Bhaker (Shooting).

Key Initiatives

- **Khelo India Games:** Talent identification at multiple levels.
- **Focus on infrastructure,** anti-doping, and private sector partnerships.



Early Success (1900):
Norman Pritchard won 2 silver medals in athletics.

Hockey Dominance
(1928-1980): 8 gold medals.

Notable Wins: Leander Paes (bronze, 1996), Karnam Malleswari (bronze, 2000).



Recent Achievements:
Rajyavardhan Rathore (silver, 2004), Abhinav Bindra (gold, 2008).

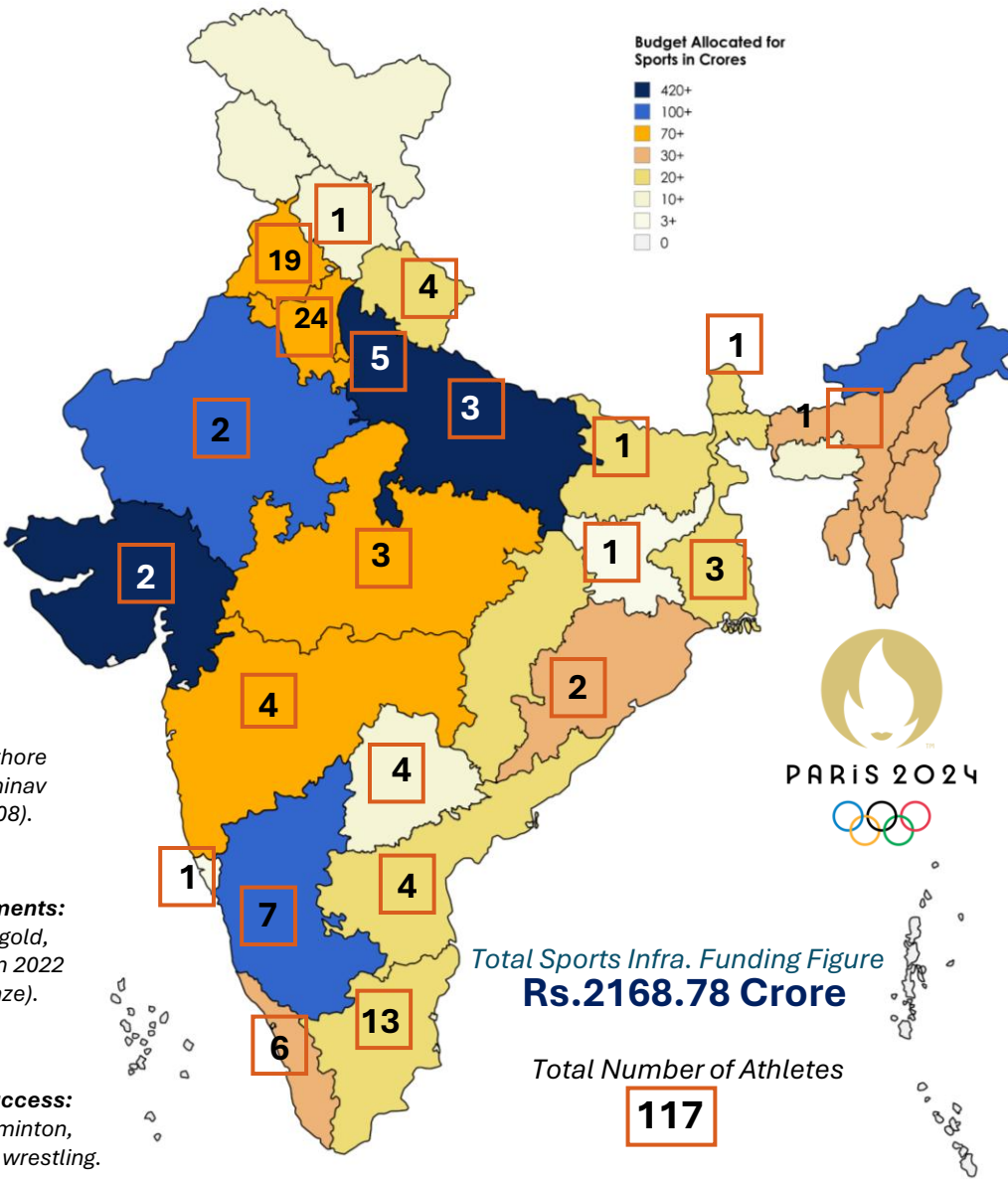
Recent Achievements:
Neeraj Chopra (gold, 2020), 6 medals in 2022 (1 silver, 5 bronze).

Diversified Success:
Growth in badminton, weightlifting, and wrestling.

Finance & Budget

- **Total FY2024 budget:** ₹3,442.32 crore; Khelo India gets ₹900 crore.
- **TOPS Scheme:** Supports Olympic athletes with financial aid for training and competitions.

India in Olympics

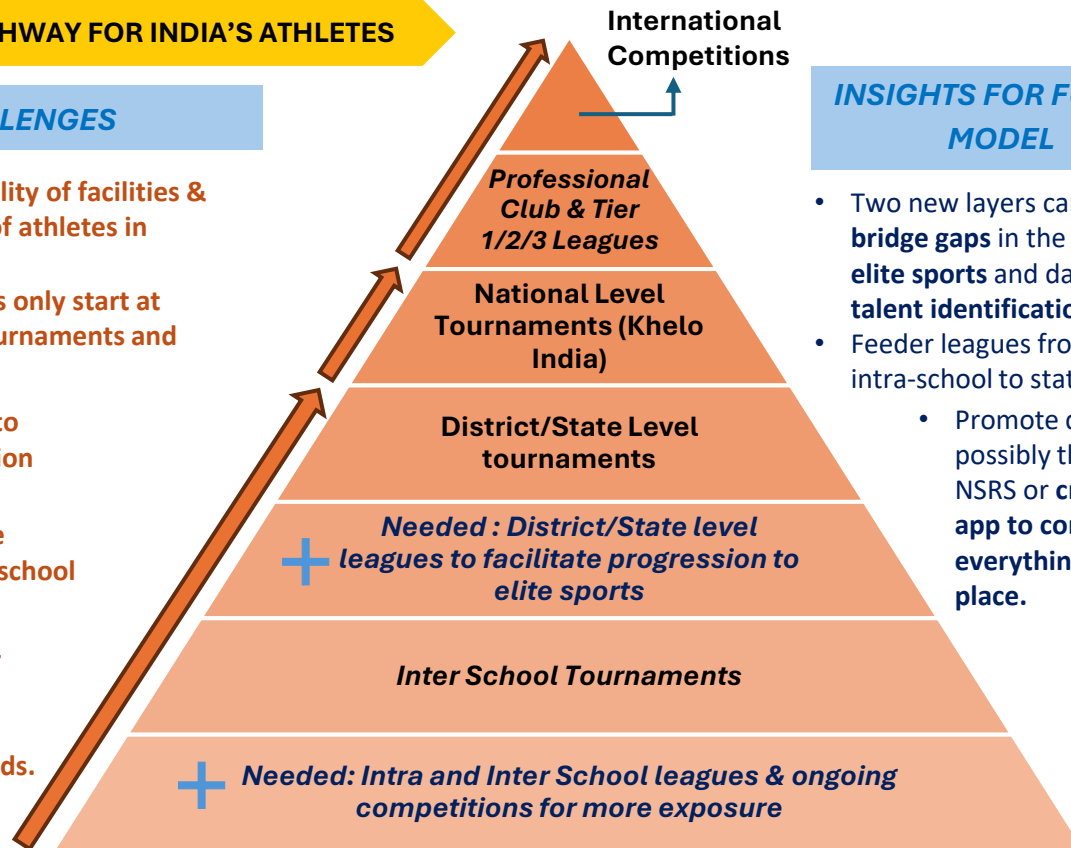


UNDERSTANDING THE ATHLETES & STAKEHOLDERS

CURRENT PATHWAY FOR INDIA'S ATHLETES

CHALLENGES

- Downgraded quality of facilities & poor treatment of athletes in National Level.
- Grassroots efforts only start at national-level tournaments and Khelo India.
- Lack of exposure to real-life competition scenarios.
- Player profiles are unavailable from school level upwards
- Absence of player profiles and standardised evaluation methods.



INSIGHTS FOR FUTURE MODEL

- Two new layers can help **bridge gaps** in the path to **elite sports** and data-backed **talent identification**.
- Feeder leagues from the intra-school to state levels.
 - Promote digitisation, possibly through NSRS or **create an app to consolidate everything at one place.**

The Think Sports Index

The **Think Sports Index** assesses nations on sports development across **commercial, performance, and heritage dimensions**, including factors like **market performance, fandoms, global events, and public spending**.

1		US
2		UK
3		Australia
12		South Korea
13		India

This shows that **Indian players** come from a **diverse and evolving background**, reflecting the nation's **growing ambition and potential to excel**.

STAKEHOLDER IDENTIFICATION & ANALYSIS



Govt. Bodies

- **Roles:** Policy formulation, funding, and regulatory oversight.
- **Examples:** Ministry of Sports, local governing bodies, education boards.



Educational Institutions

- **Roles:** Implementation of sports quotas, infrastructure provision.
- **Examples:** Schools, colleges, and universities.



Sports Bodies

- **Roles:** Talent scouting, organizing tournaments, and mentoring athletes.
- **Examples:** National and state-level sports federations.



Pvt. Sector & Sponsors

- **Roles:** Funding, PPPs, and infrastructure development.
- **Examples:** Corporate sponsors, private sports academies.



Coaches & Scouts

- **Roles:** Funding, PPPs, and infrastructure development.
- **Examples:** Corporate sponsors, private sports academies.



Athletes & Families

- **Roles:** Funding, PPPs, and infrastructure development.
- **Examples:** Corporate sponsors, private sports academies.



Community & Media

- **Roles:** Raising awareness and showcasing success stories to shift mindsets.
- **Examples:** Local clubs, media organizations, social influencers

RESOURCE MAPPING

**Fact Check**

**FINANCIAL RESOURCES**

**CURRENT STATUS**

₹3,442.32 Crore
Total sports budget for 2024-2025

₹900 Crore
Allocation for Khelo India Programme

₹822.60 Crore
SAI budget for 2024-2025

₹340 crore.
Assistance to National Sports Federations

**CHALLENGES**

- Limited Budgets:** Lags behind global standards, restricting growth
- Uneven Distribution of Funds:** Grassroots programs often get less funding compared to programs for elite athletes.
- Overdependence on the Government:** Heavy reliance on government support hinders private investments in the sports sector.
- Funding Disparity:** Some sports, like cricket, receive far more financial backing than others.

**INFRASTRUCTURE RESOURCES**

**CURRENT STATUS**

23 centres
National centres of excellence

1000 centres
Khelo India Centres

₹5,000- ₹25,000
Grants received by Govt. Schools for sports

**CHALLENGES**

- Uneven Availability:** Sports facilities are mostly concentrated in cities.
- Poor Upkeep:** Many existing facilities are poorly maintained and often remain underused.
- Inaccessibility for All:** Infrastructure often fails to cater to differently-abled athletes, limiting inclusivity.
- High Costs:** Building new, world-class facilities is expensive, leading to reliance on outdated ones.

**TECHNOLOGICAL RESOURCES**

**CURRENT STATUS**

18%
Expected CAGR of Indian Sports Tech Market

30%
Of grassroots sports teams in India utilize wearable devices to monitor athlete performance

\$6.69 billion
Global AI in Sports Market by 2030

**CHALLENGES**

- Restricted Access:** Advanced tools are mostly limited to top-tier athletes.
- Digital Divide:** Limited internet access and low awareness in rural areas
- High Costs:** Advanced sports technologies are often expensive.
- Skill Gaps:** Coaches and staff lack adequate training in using sports technology to help athletes perform better.

**HUMAN RESOURCES**

**CURRENT STATUS**

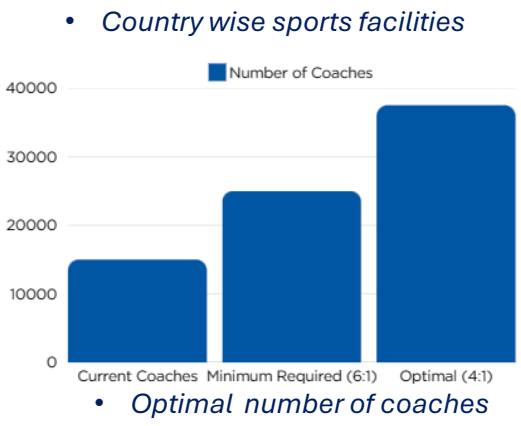
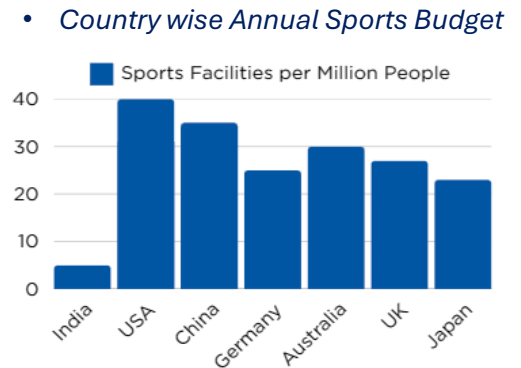
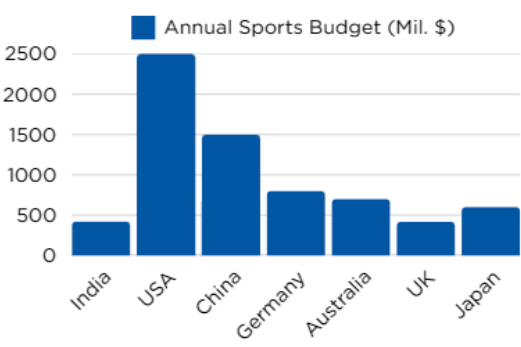
33.3%
Women in coaching and sports science staff in India, with less than 10% holding head coach.

1:40
Coach-to-athlete ratio of 1:40; critical shortage of certified trainers

398 coaches
In total appointed by SAI for Olympics 2024 and 2028

**CHALLENGES**

- Coach Shortages:** There's an insufficient number of coaches, particularly in rural areas.
- Outdated Training Methods:** Many coaches lack access to modern training techniques and approaches.
- Gender Gap:** Women are underrepresented in coaching.
- Lack of Support Experts:** Scarcity of essential support staff such as physiotherapists, sports psychologists, and nutritionists.



PROBLEM STRUCTURING AND PRIORITIZATION

Societal Norms and Gender Bias

- Sports are often seen as **hobbies rather than career paths**, discouraging participation, especially among women who face additional pressures **to prioritize academics** or traditional roles.
- A **lack of visible female role models** and career security reinforces this mindset.

Only
29%

of Indian Women
engage in sports

Source : BBC



Supporting Example

Wrestler **Vinesh Phogat** openly spoke about the **discrimination female wrestlers** face in training facilities compared to male counterparts.

WHY THIS PROBLEM?

Achieving **100 Olympic medals** will drive **national unity, integration, and India's soft power projection**, fostering **aspirations, national pride, economic growth, and international prestige**, essential for a **Viksit Bharat**.

CHALLENGES IN ACHIEVING 100 OLYMPIC MEDALS BY 2037

Governance Gaps and Policy Inefficiencies

- **Administrative delays, weak governance, and inconsistent policy enforcement** hinder athlete participation.
- Limited inclusive policies and uneven funding distribution contribute to disparities in access to sports resources.

Rs. 1000 Cr+
Funding Delays

10 states in India
receive **18%**
of total sports funding



Supporting Example

Neeraj Chopra had to rely on **private sponsors** for foreign training, highlighting the need for **timely fund disbursement** for global competitiveness.

Challenges in Athlete Support & Infrastructure

- Limited access to quality training facilities, coaching, and platforms.
- **Poor facilities at national level**: bad accommodation, no female attendants, less medical support at field, and low travel reimbursements.
- **Decline in support** from state to national level.
- **Low-growth government jobs** (e.g., railways) offered to athletes who struggle to sustain performance, discouraging **less-publicized sports**.

India has only

100

sports facilities
meeting international
standards.

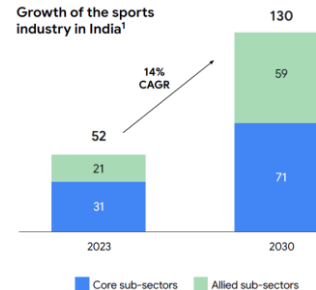
Testimonial

"National-level support is poor—bad accommodation, **no female attendants, and minimal travel reimbursements**. State-level support is better, but many athletes in lesser-known sports end up in low-growth jobs."

—National-Level Carrom and Swimming Athletes



Growth of the sports industry in India¹



India's sports sector is projected to reach **\$130 Bil.** By 2030, growing **twice the rate of national GDP.**

Lack of Early Talent Identification

- **Outdated scouting systems** and a lack of grassroots programs result in **missed opportunities to identify and nurture** promising athletes, especially in underrepresented regions and sports.
- This leads to **players receiving very less training** compared to the optimal training needed for Olympic Games.

Only
10%

of institutions reported
improvements in talent
development

Testimonial

"India's Olympic training is too short—1-2 years instead of the **ideal 5-10 years**. Talent identification happens too late, only at the national level. **Sports tech and facilities are lacking**, forcing top athletes like **Neeraj Chopra to train abroad**."

—Head Coach at IIT Guwahati



RECOMMENDATIONS

CHANGING ATTITUDE TOWARDS SPORTS



Schooling & Career

- **Scholarships & Quotas:** Expand **merit-based scholarships** and **reserved admissions** for athletes.
- **Community Awareness Campaigns:** Feature athlete **success stories** via **OTT, billboards, and social media** to normalize sports careers.
- **Workshops for Parents & Teachers:** Provide **structured programs on sports benefits** with certification for teachers integrating sports learning.

Reimagining curriculums & Physical Education

PE as a Core Subject

Make sports a graded academic component and integrate 'sports GPA' tracking in schools.

Career Awareness & AI-Based Guidance

Deploy AI aptitude tests to help students explore careers in sports sciences, coaching, and analytics

Optimizing Space Usage

Convert unused school areas (corridors, rooftops) into small sports zones.

Diversified Sports Training

Introduce region-specific sports (Kabaddi in Haryana, Football in Bengal, etc.)

Gamified Sports Learning

Use fitness apps, VR sports simulations, and leaderboard tracking for engagement.

Encouraging Team-Based Play

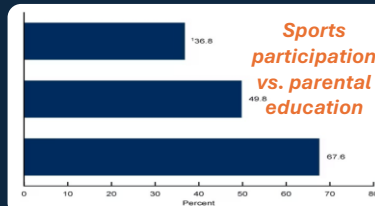
Move beyond military-style drills to interactive, cooperative exercises fostering teamwork.

70%

of Olympic athletes in countries with **strong school-level sports scholarships** come through **high school & college funding programs**.

50%

increase in **children's sports participation** when **parents are more educated & actively support the child's sport**.



AREAS OF IMPACT

- Resources
- Institutions
- Athlete Development.

CHANNELS OF IMPACT

- Social Mobility & Equity
- National Integration
- International Prestige

PRINCIPLES OF IMPACT

- Equity
- Quality
- Efficiency

IMPROVING TALENT ACQUISITION

Grassroots Talent Discovery

Village & District-Level Scouting
Establish **talent scouting committees** in villages and districts to identify young athletes early.

Modeled on the **Special Area Games Scheme**

Integration with Existing Programs
Leverage national initiatives like **Khelo India**, which aims to **revive sports culture** at the **grassroots level**.

Competitions & Training Ecosystem

Regional Tournaments for Talent Identification – **Conduct regular district and state-level tournaments**

The **Khelo India Youth Games & National Coaching Scheme** serve as a model.

Incorporating Indigenous Sports – Promote **traditional Indian games** in talent hunts to identify unique talent. **Incentives for Coaches & Scouts.**

Community & Athlete Support System

Role Models & Local Champions – Engage successful athletes from similar backgrounds to inspire and mentor young talent.

The **Biju Patnaik Rural Hockey Championships** serve as a model.

NSRS DIGITIZATION

NSRS is a centralized digital platform that tracks athlete data ensuring **structured talent development**.

- **Mandating performance recording.**
- **Location-independent data access** ensures fair selection.
- Digital records help **scouts & schools target talent early & efficiently**.

AREAS OF IMPACT

- Athlete Development.
- Infrastructural Development
- Developing an eco-system

CHANNELS OF IMPACT

- National Integration
- Fulfilment of aspirations
- Social Engagement

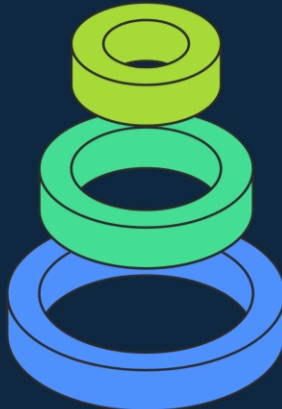
PRINCIPLES OF IMPACT

- Scale
- Efficiency
- Responsiveness

LEGISLATIVE REFORMS FOR A STRONGER SPORTS FUTURE

Addressing sports funding disparity

- Playground Mandates**
Zoning policies mandate playgrounds in residential areas
- NSF-SSF Collaboration**
Stronger oversight ensures equal training opportunities
- Central-State Programs**
Initiatives like Khelo India drive uniform development



Strengthening Governance

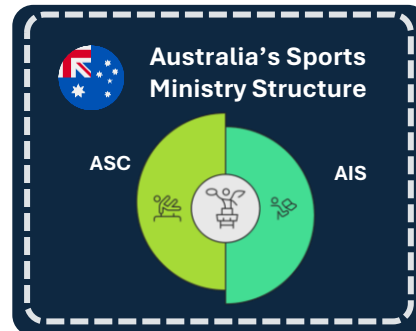
- 1. Faster Fund Disbursement** – Ensure **timely financial aid** to prevent training disruptions.
- 2. Independent Directors & Transparency** – Strengthen oversight with **whistleblower protection policies** and open governance.
- 3. Professionalized Governance** – Streamline roles and decision-making in NSFs & SSFs.
- 4. Education & Ethics Programs** – Expand training on **doping, substance abuse, and ethical governance**.



Approach for Elite & Grassroots Sports

Managing both elite and grassroots sports under one framework **limits tailored development** for each.

- 1. Dedicated Governance Bodies** – Adopt **Australia's model**, where ASC manages mass participation and AIS focuses on elite training.
- 2. Grassroots Strengthening** – Implement **structured physical education programs and specialized youth coaching** to nurture talent early.
- 3. Elite Sports Advancement** – Follow the **UK & US approach** of separate governance for grassroots and high-performance sports.



AREAS OF IMPACT

- Athlete Development
- Infrastructure
- System

CHANNELS OF IMPACT

- Social Mobility & Equity
- National Integration
- Fulfillment of Aspirations

PRINCIPLES OF IMPACT

- Quality
- Equity
- Responsiveness

STRENGTHENING SPORTS INFRASTRUCTURE IN INDIA

Tier 1 Cities

Focus on Olympic-level training with multi-sport stadiums and high-performance centers, funded by PPPs and corporate sponsorships.



Tier 3 Cities

Emphasize amateur and grassroots development with community sports complexes, funded by low-cost infrastructure and community memberships.



Tier 2 Cities

Develop national-level training centers and sport-specific academies, supported by state grants and university partnerships.

■ Tier 1 (Metro Cities, Pop. 5M+)

■ Tier 2 (Urban Centers, Pop. 1M–5M)

■ Tier 3 (Small Towns, Pop. <1M)

- **Centralized Sports Facility Database** – Use the **Khelo India Playfield Repository** for **facility tracking, easy booking, audits, and maintenance monitoring**.
- **Policy Reforms & Private Investments** – Encourage **tax incentives, corporate sponsorships, and PPPs**.
- **Multi-Purpose & High-Durability Infrastructure** – Develop **stadiums with all-weather surfaces**, integrating **sports, entertainment, and cultural venues** for sustainability.
- **Maximizing Facility Utilization** – Open **government-owned sports complexes** for public use during non-peak hours.
- **Population-Based Sports Planning** – Mandate **playgrounds in residential zones**, ensuring **school and college sports facilities** are part of urban planning.
- **Innovative Funding & Self-Sustaining Models** – Leverage **CSR funds, naming rights, and stadium IPs** to create **financially viable sports infrastructure**.

AREAS OF IMPACT

- Infrastructure
- System (Governance)
- Resources.

CHANNELS OF IMPACT

- National Integration
- Social Mobility & Equity
- Economic Growth

PRINCIPLES OF IMPACT

- Quality
- Efficiency
- Affordability

EVERYTHING AT ONE PLACE - INTRODUCING “KHEL CONNECT”

Tech Adoption in Indian Sports Sector

Grassroots Development

Current state of tech adoption



- Low technology adoption in **identifying and nurturing talent**.
- Limited **exposure to opportunities** for **rural and semi-urban** athletes.
- Insufficient **community engagement** between athletes, coaches, and parents.

Performance Management

Current state of tech adoption



- Low technology adoption in **identifying and nurturing talent**.
- Limited **exposure to opportunities** for **rural and semi-urban** athletes.
- Insufficient **community engagement** between athletes, coaches, and parents.

PROPOSED FEATURES OF KhelConnect

Talent Scouting

Tracks athlete performance to discover untapped talent, particularly in rural areas.



Inclusivity Support

Offers FAQs and 24/7 live chat support with multilingual options for diverse users.



Infrastructure

Features a sports map to locate training centers and assist policymakers.



Rewards System

Sends timely updates on events and competitions, with SMS notifications for accessibility.



KhelConnect

“Bridging Talent, Building Champions”

Community Engagement

Provides forums and leaderboards for athletes, parents, and coaches to connect and share tips.



Equipment Access

Enables affordable rentals and donations of sports gear through partnerships.



Notifications

Sends timely updates on events and competitions, with SMS notifications for accessibility.



AREAS OF IMPACT

- *Social Enablers*
- *Infrastructure*
- *Institutions*
- *System*
- *Resources*
- *Athlete Development*

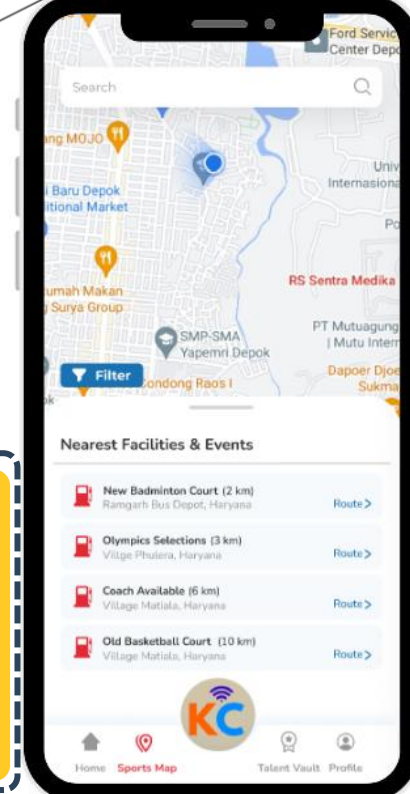
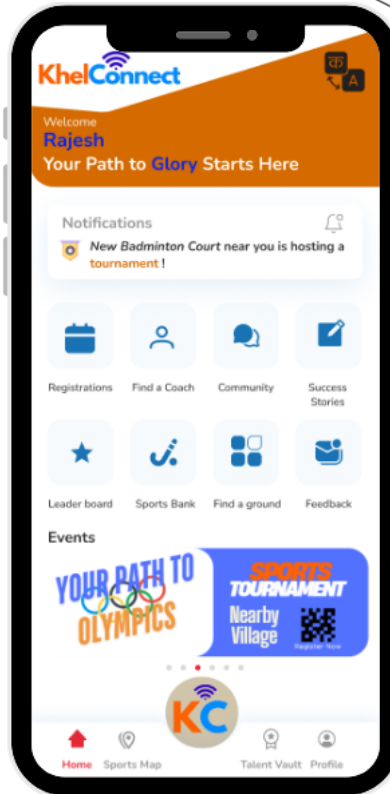
CHANNELS OF IMPACT

- International Prestige
- National Pride
- Economic Growth
- National Integration
- Societal Engagement

PRINCIPLES OF IMPACT

- Scale
- Affordability
- Responsiveness
- Equity
- Quality
- Efficiency

User Flow



IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Building A Strong Talent Pool (4 step process)

APPROACHES

1

Mandate recreational play from primary school onwards

- Revamp PE curriculum in schools with input from **experts** like therapists, nutritionists, and wellness specialists.
- Promote **diverse physical activities** to include all children, **not just the strongest**.

2

Build a steady pipeline of high caliber coaches and PE teachers

- Update sports education curriculums with global best practices.
- Upskill PE teachers and coaches regularly on latest trends.
- Provide opportunities to shadow professional/university-level coaches.

3

Facilitate access to competitions and talent identification

- Mandate **intra-school sports leagues** with regular competitions.
- Create a **centralized system to track and document** athlete performance over time.
- Provide **scholarships and incentives** for young athletes.

4

Pave a path to elite sports, removing roadblocks

- Establish a **merit-based tiered league system** for athletes to progress.
- Provide support like scholarships and **academic advisors** for student-athletes.
- Facilitate mentorship programs to guide athletes through transitions between competitive levels.

More kids play sports (Step 1) → Identified & trained by quality coaches (Step 2) → Given access to competitions (Step 3) → Progress into elite sports (Step 4)

Phase 1:

Foundation & Development (Year 1)

- **Grassroots & Talent Discovery** – Launch district scouting, AI aptitude tests, and NSRS tracking.
- **Infrastructure & Access** – Audit sports facilities, open govt. centers, and introduce private funding incentives.
- **Awareness & Governance** – Make PE a core subject, run community campaigns, and digitize funding processes.
- **Khel Connect Development** – Design UI/UX, set up backend, and integrate initial athlete database.

Phase II:

Infrastructure & Governance (Year 2)

- **Coaching & Athlete Training** – Coach certification, mandatory upskilling, mentorship programs.
- **Technology & Structured Pathway** – AI talent scouting (Khel Connect), tiered league system, scholarships.
- **Khel Connect Testing** – Beta testing with athletes, coaches, and federations, system refinements.
- **Governance & Transparency** – Establish a Sports Ombudsman, link funding to athlete performance.

Phase III:

Deployment & Expansion (Years 3-4)

- **Infrastructure & Training Centers** – Upgrade facilities, expand regional hubs, scale long-term athlete training.
- **Khel Connect Deployment** – Official launch, onboarding for athletes & coaches, nationwide integration.
- **Digitization & Performance Tracking** – Expand NSRS, automate scouting & analytics.
- **Financial Support & Expansion** – Expand scholarships, incentivize coaching, and increase funding support.

Phase IV:

Sustainability & Global Initiatives (Year 5)

- **World-Class Infrastructure** – Fully operational elite training centers & specialized regional hubs.
- **Long-Term Athlete Development** – Structured 10+ year coaching pipeline, Khelo India integration.
- **Khel Connect Optimization** – AI-powered athlete insights, predictive analytics, international expansion.
- **Sustainable Funding** – PPP models, corporate sponsorships, self-sustaining sports academies.

Executive Summary

Current Landscape

Athletes & Stakeholders

Resources

Problems

Solutions

Implementation

Financials

Appendix

INVESTMENT OUTLAY REQUIRED

PROJECTED BUDGET ACROSS ALL DOMAINS OVER 5 YEARS

INFRASTRUCTURE

Tier 1 - Metro Cities ₹5,500 Cr

- High-Performance Centers (5 × ₹600 Cr) → ₹3,000 Cr
- Multi-Sport Stadiums (5 × ₹500 Cr) → ₹2,500 Cr

Tier 2 - Urban Cities ₹3,500 Cr

- Training Academies (10 × ₹200 Cr) → ₹2,000 Cr
- Upgraded Stadiums (10 × ₹150 Cr) → ₹1,500 Cr

Tier 3 - Rural & Semi-Urban Areas ₹2,500 Cr

- Community Sports Hubs (25 × ₹60 Cr) → ₹1,500 Cr
- Basic Sports Facilities (25 × ₹40 Cr) → ₹1,000 Cr

Other Expenses ₹20,000 Cr

- Upgrading School & College Sports Infrastructure → ₹10,000 Cr
- Smart Sports Infrastructure → ₹5,000 Cr
- Land costs for new facilities → ₹2,500 Cr
- Regular maintenance, safety audits, and repair of sports facilities → ₹2,500 Cr

₹22,500 Cr (~\$2.7B)

TALENT ACQUISITION

Elite International Coaches ₹1,000 Cr

(500 × ₹2 Cr salary/year × 5 years)

National-Level Coaches ₹750 Cr

(750 × ₹1 Cr salary/year × 5 years)

Grassroots Coaching Network ₹2,000 Cr

(10,000 coaches × ₹4L salary × 5 years)

Hiring Performance Analysts, Physios, Rehab Specialists ₹1,000 Cr

Training Programs for Coaches ₹500 Cr

₹5,000 Cr (~\$600M)

GOVERNANCE & POLICIES

Sports Ombudsman & Ethics Committees ₹250 Cr

Policy drafting (₹200 Cr), compliance monitoring (₹150 Cr), and legal enforcement (₹150 Cr).

Governance Digitalization ₹750 Cr

Funds AI-driven fund tracking (₹250 Cr), athlete data integration (₹200 Cr), and portal upgrades (₹300 Cr).

Regulatory Reforms & Sports Laws ₹500 Cr

Ombudsman (₹100 Cr), anti-doping & ethics committees (₹75 Cr), and training programs (₹75 Cr).

₹1,250 Cr (~\$150M)

COMPETITIONS

Khelo India Expansion ₹2,500 Cr

Merit-Based Scholarships ₹2,500 Cr

50,000 athletes × ₹5L each

Competition Hosting ₹2,000 Cr

Infrastructure, logistics, sponsorships

Performance-Based Cash Incentives ₹1,500 Cr

₹8,500 Cr (~\$1B)

TECHNOLOGY ADOPTION

Khel Connect Development ₹500 Cr

App UI/UX, Backend, Testing

NSRS Expansion ₹200 Cr

Athlete database integration

Governance Digitalization ₹250 Cr

Fund tracking, athlete selection transparency

Sports Science ₹700 Cr

Data Analytics & AI Monitoring ₹400 Cr
AI-Driven Scouting Tools & Machine Learning ₹300 Cr

₹1,250 Cr (~\$150M)



Projected Annual Allocation

₹38,750 Cr

Countries like **China, the USA, and the UK** significantly increased sports funding, leading to **Olympic success and elite athlete development**. The UK's 2.5x budget rise post-2012 boosted medals. To compete globally, **India must scale investments in infrastructure, scouting, and athlete support**.

Total Budget over 5 years

*"A nation's sporting success is not
built in a day, but in the years of
investment, opportunity, and belief
we place in our athletes today."*

Thank you

*Saanchi Gupta
Abhishek Das*



Appendix

Sources

- **Australia's Olympic Funding Model:** Australia invests approximately A\$150 million annually through the Australian Institute of Sport (AIS) to support high-performance athletes.
 - [theguardian.com](https://www.theguardian.com)
- **United Kingdom's National Lottery Funding:** The UK's National Lottery has raised over £90 billion in 30 years, significantly contributing to sports funding and Olympic success.
 - [theaustralian.com.au](https://www.theaustralian.com.au)
- **India's Khelo India Scheme:** The Khelo India program aims to promote sports at the grassroots level, with a budget allocation of ₹900 crore in the Union Budget 2024-25.
 - [m.economictimes.com](https://www.m.economictimes.com)
- **China's Sports Investment:** China has been increasing its investment in sports infrastructure and development, viewing the Paris 2024 Olympics as an opportunity to enhance its global image and boost trade through sports-related exports.
 - [china-briefing.com](https://www.china-briefing.com)
- **India's Sports Budget Allocation:** In the Union Budget 2024-25, the sports sector in India received a record allocation of ₹3,442 crores, with a significant portion dedicated to the Khelo India initiative.
 - [ddnews.gov.in](https://www.ddnews.gov.in)
- **Think Sports: Unlocking India's \$130B Sports Potential'** is a research report published by Deloitte & Google, which analyzes India's evolving sports landscape.
- **France's Sports Funding:** France allocates nearly €40 billion annually to sports, supported by public funding, private spending, and specific allocations for major sporting events.
 - [projectplay.org](https://www.projectplay.org)
- **Khelo India Scheme's State-wise Allocation:** The Khelo India Scheme, initiated in October 2017 with a total budget of ₹1,756 crore, has allocated funds across various states for sports infrastructure development.
 - [pib.gov.in](https://www.pib.gov.in)
- **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports Budget Allocation:** The Ministry's budget includes allocations for youth welfare schemes, sports infrastructure, and development programs.
 - [openbudgetsindia.org](https://www.openbudgetsindia.org)
- **International Olympic Committee (IOC) Funding:** The IOC is a non-profit organization dedicated to using revenue generated from the Olympic Games to assist athletes and develop sports worldwide.
 - [olympics.com](https://www.olympics.com)
- **Comparative Analysis of Elite Sport Policies:** A study comparing elite sport policies in six countries provides insights into different funding models and their effectiveness.
 - [researchgate.net](https://www.researchgate.net)

Appendix

Age Demographics

The median age of Indian Athletes is about **28 years**

- India presents a massive pool of potential talent.
- The challenge lies in tapping into this age group early, ensuring proper training and development pathways.

Women in Sports

Tokyo 2020: 44% of India's 121 athletes were female.

Paris 2024: 40% of India's 117 athletes were female.

- Female representation in sports is improving, but societal and infrastructural challenges exist.
- A focus on equitable access and safety for female athletes is vital for growth.

Regional Data

- Haryana, Punjab, Kerala:** Lead in wrestling, shooting, and athletics.
- Northeast:** Excels with natural talent and government support (e.g., Mary Kom).
- UP, Bihar:** Underrepresented due to limited sports infrastructure.

Socioeconomic Barriers

- Only **1%** of youth **actively participate** in sports, despite **62%** expressing interest.

Socioeconomic barriers are a significant **hindrance to participation**, especially in costly sports like shooting and tennis.



Some key challenges

Indian children only get **20% – or 86 of the WHO-recommended 420 minutes¹ – of exercise per week. 3 in 4 kids lack adequate aerobic capacity².**

India's PE curriculums currently do not meet global standards of 'play-based' teaching methods. This leaves Indian children at a disadvantage, including life-long negative attitudes towards exercise and play.

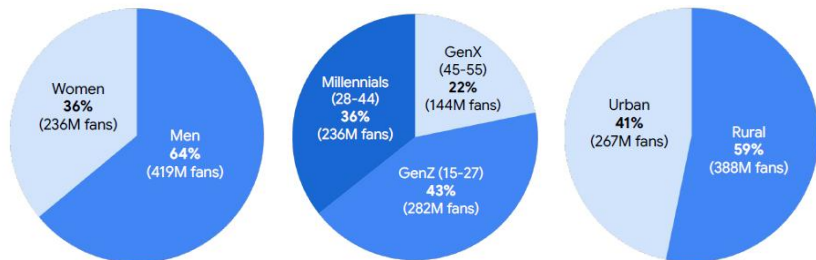
73% of India's school-going children attend government schools³, presenting a golden opportunity for intervention.

India faces a severe shortage of PE teachers

Almost half of India's schools – 7.5 to 8 lakh – have vacant PE teacher roles¹. A study of 17,000 upper-primary government schools across India revealed that **only 31% of them had a designated PE teacher**; this number falls to 4% for primary schools².

Fan Base

The graphs highlight a dynamic shift in India's sports fanbase: **36% are women, 43% are Gen Z, and 59% come from rural areas**, showcasing growing diversity and breaking traditional barriers in sports engagement.



Bhaichung Bhutia

Former captain, Indian football team

Challenges

01

A lack of quality coaches at the grassroots and at the elite level. There is limited understanding of how to conduct training programmes for young kids.

02

Young athletes have little to no established pathway to elite sports. Not many young players and clubs have access to AIFF's Youth League system at the U-13, U-15 and U-17 levels.

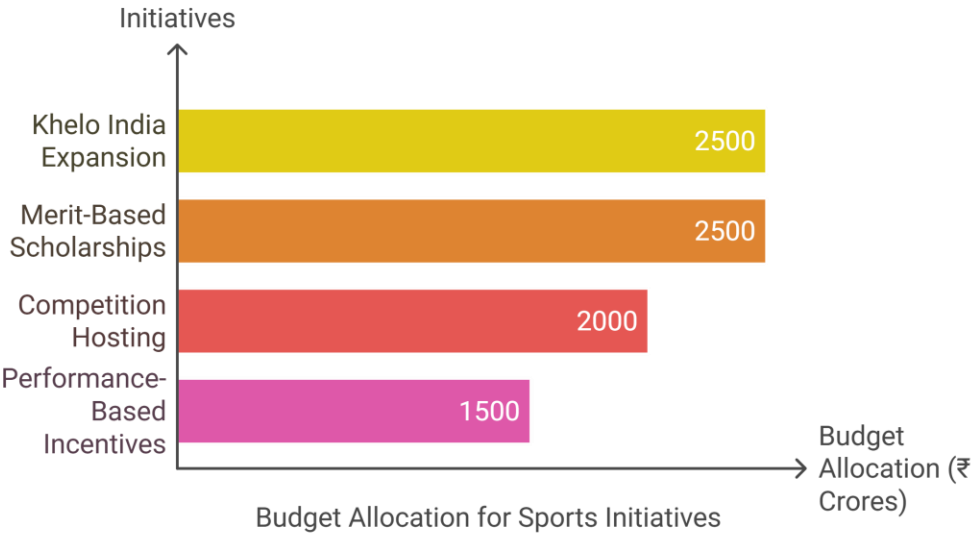
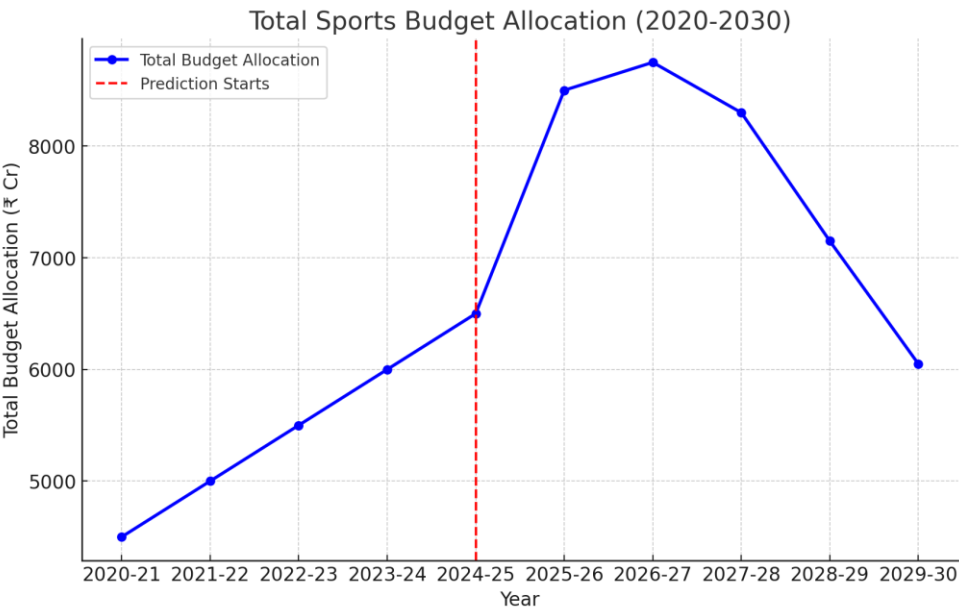
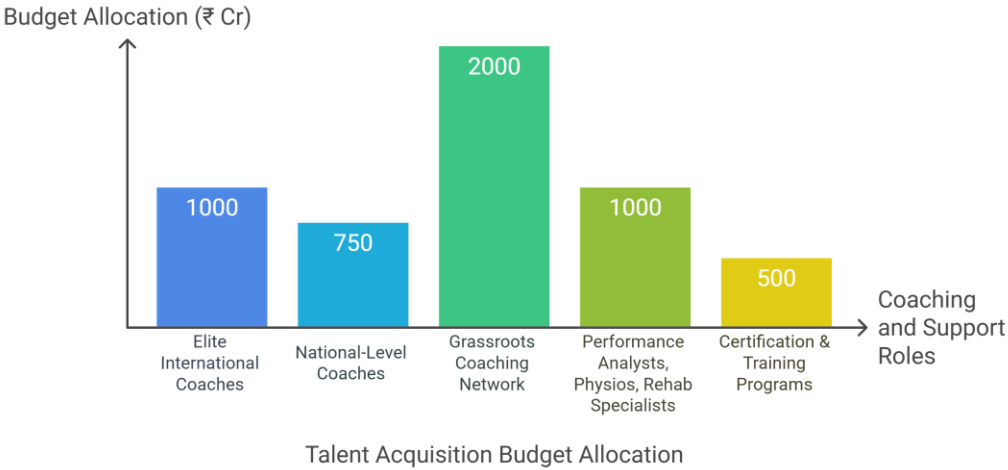
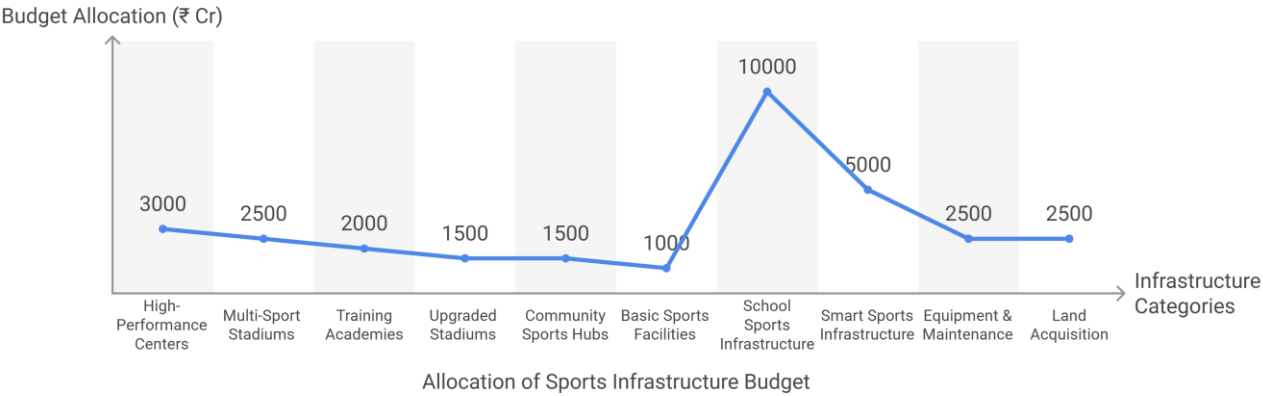
03

Scarce football turfs or well-maintained grass playgrounds mean players have too little practice time.

ANALYSIS OF PRESENT INITIATIVES

SCHEME/PROGRAM	OBJECTIVE	KEY STATISTICS	IDENTIFIED PROBLEMS	POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS
 Khelo India Talent Development Scheme	Identify and develop talent for national and international sport	15,000 athletes identified; 20% advanced to national-level competitions	- Financial constraints Limited access to advanced training centers	Expand athlete stipends, develop advanced training centers in tier-2/3 cities , increase awareness
 SAI National Centers of Excellence (NCOE)	Provide high-performance training facilities	4354 athletes enrolled; 25% transitioned to national competitions	Inconsistent funding, - lack of sports science support	Regular funding , mandatory sports science teams, focus on upgrading facilities
 Khelo India State Centers of Excellence (KISCE)	Regional hubs for training in Olympic disciplines	30% of athletes from KISCE reached national competitions	Uneven geographic distribution limited awareness in rural areas	Establish additional KISCES in underserved regions , conduct awareness campaigns
 Sports Authority of India (SAI)	Support and exposure for athletes in international sports	Over 1,500 athletes received international exposure in 2022-23	Limited exposure for women athletes high dependency on federations	Introduce women-focused programs , diversify funding sources, engage with private sponsor
 National Youth Festival (Khelo India)	Promote national integration through competitive events	1,200 volunteers in national-level camps; 200 participated in Republic Day Parade	- Focus on cultural activities over sports - low sports recognition	Increase sports representation, integrate local-level competitions for broader youth participation
 National Service Scheme (NSS)	Engage youth in national camps and adventure programs	Annual 5% increase in athletes progressing to international competitions	Limited transition from volunteerism to competitive sports	Align NSS activities with talent scouting efforts , connect with SAI for athlete identification
 NSF (National Sports Federations)	Train athletes for international competitions	60% of professional athletes face financial difficulties within five years of retirement	- Federation-specific biases, - lack of grassroots connections	Monitor federations' performance, ensure equal support across regions, improve scouting mechanisms

Projected Budget Allocations



APPENDIX

National-level policies and initiatives

Target Olympic Podium Scheme (2014, run by MYAS)

Identifies potential Olympic-calibre athletes and provides them with training, equipment, competitive opportunities and financial support.

The program supports 300 top-calibre athletes with a monthly stipend.

Achieved

28

medals at the 2024 Olympics and Paralympic Games²

Khelo India Program (2018, run by MYAS and SAI)

Aims to revive India's sporting culture with robust grassroots initiatives and programs.

The first effective program of this kind, Khelo focuses on scouting, competition exposure, fitness at schools, academy development, women's sports, sports for people with disabilities and indigenous sports.

5600

young athletes participated in KIYG 2024

2840 were designated as Khelo India Athletes³

Fit India Movement (2019, run by MYAS)

Promotes active lifestyles and physical fitness, with a focus on schools and colleges.

The FIT India Freedom Run saw

71M

participants in 2022 while the FIT India Quiz had 175.5K students register from 42,490 schools⁴

Recent state-level policies and initiatives

Odisha's focus on infrastructure

Development of state-of-the-art sports infrastructure with a focus on high-performance centres and academies.

Nurtures talent across the state, with a focus on infrastructure development beyond key cities.

The Kalinga Sports Complex and the Birs Munda Stadium are widely considered best-in-class and are in line with leading international standards.

48

multi-purpose indoor stadiums are currently under development⁵

Uttar Pradesh Sports Policy 2023

Revamped state policies that promote e-sports, sports goods manufacturing, elite sports pathways, financial aid for athletes and support the indigenous, women and Paralympic athletes.

Emphasises infrastructure development by building sports centres in every district and opening gyms in rural areas.

Established

14

Centres of Excellence for specific sports via public-private partnerships (PPP)⁵

Punjab Sports Policy 2023

Introduced policies to nurture enthusiasm and sports performance, and provide every strata of society with sufficient facilities, coaches and administrative staff.

Increased financial incentives for Olympic medalists.

1000

cluster-level sports nurseries¹ and 200 district-level sports hostels are to be established⁵

BREAKING BARRIERS: THE JOURNEY OF A NATIONAL TENNIS PLAYER



National-Level Tennis Player | Advocate for Better Sports Infrastructure & Financial Support in India

Profile

- *National-level tennis player with a journey from local to state & national tournaments*
- *Overcame **financial, logistical, and infrastructure barriers** to compete at the highest level*
- *Passionate about **sports accessibility, funding, and long-term athlete support***



JOURNEY INTO TENNIS

The player's **tennis journey began as a child**, when his father **enrolled him in a summer camp** to engage in sports. He progressed through **local and state tournaments**, eventually aiming for **national-level competition**.

However, the road was **not easy**:

- **Lack of exposure to national tournaments** due to financial constraints and limited tournaments in Tamil Nadu.
- **Language barriers, travel costs, and lack of financial independence** restricted participation in key tournaments.
- **High costs of training, coaching, travel, and medical care** created **huge financial pressure**.

Despite these challenges, **he pursued national-level tournaments after gaining some independence**, driven by **hunger to compete at the top**.

Challenges & Advocacy

Infrastructure & Injury Recovery – While **good training facilities** were available, the **lack of quality sports physiotherapists and doctors** made injury management difficult.

Financial Challenges in Tennis –

- **Tennis is financially demanding**, with significant **costs for travel, stay, coaching, equipment, and medical care**.
- **Prize money from tournaments barely covers travel expenses**, making sponsorships essential.

Role of Schools, Colleges & Clubs –

- **Schools & colleges must actively support athletes**, providing **leave approvals, sponsorships, and tournament funding**.
- **Local clubs play a key role** in securing sponsorships and promoting local talent.

Gaps in Government Support & Tournament Structure –

- Current government schemes benefit only top-ranked players, leaving others without long-term financial backing.
- More tournaments should be spread throughout the year rather than a few big ones, ensuring continuous exposure for players.

Vision for the Future of Indian Tennis

- Better financial support & structured funding to make tennis a viable career for young athletes.
- Increased government investment in sports infrastructure & financial accessibility for players across all levels.
- More national & international tournaments, ensuring players get frequent opportunities and recognition.



Encouraging sports as a promising career requires financial security. We need better infrastructure, frequent tournaments, and sustainable funding to make professional tennis a viable path for young players.

Appendix

Related Facts

Career Awareness & AI-Based Guidance (Reimagining Curriculum & PE)

- Fact:** AI-driven career guidance in sports has helped increase participation in elite sports by **40%** in countries like China and Germany (Source: International Sports Data Report).
- Fact:** Career education in sports improves student motivation and engagement in physical activities by **30%** (Source: OECD Education Review).

Gamified Sports Learning (Optimizing PE & Space Usage)

- Fact:** Gamified PE programs increase student participation rates by **25%** and boost motor skill development (Source: National PE Association).
- Fact:** Schools implementing game-based learning in PE report higher engagement, better teamwork skills, and improved cognitive development (Source: British Journal of Sports Medicine).

Optimizing Space Usage (Optimizing PE & Space Usage)

- Fact:** Schools using creative space optimization for sports (e.g., multipurpose courts, community fields) increase student activity rates by **35%** (Source: Urban Sports Planning Report).
- Fact:** Small-space sports like futsal, 3v3 basketball, and modified athletics improve skill acquisition and decision-making speed by **20%** (Source: Sports Science Journal).

Encouraging Team-Based Play (Optimizing PE & Space Usage)

- Fact:** Team-based play leads to a **40% improvement in social skills, collaboration, and conflict resolution** (Source: UNICEF Sports for Development).
- Fact:** Schools promoting team sports report higher student well-being, lower stress levels, and better academic scores (Source: Journal of Adolescent Health).

Appendix

Scholarships & Quotas (Schooling & Career)

- Fact:** Studies show that financial aid and quotas increase sports participation by up to **30% in underprivileged communities** (Source: Global Sports Development Report).
- Fact:** Countries with strong school-level sports scholarships (e.g., the U.S.) produce **70% of their Olympic athletes** through high school and college-level funding programs (Source: NCAA & IOC Reports).

Community Awareness Campaigns (Schooling & Career)

- Fact:** Parental support has been linked to a **50% increase in children's participation in sports** (Source: WHO, UNICEF).
- Fact:** Awareness campaigns have led to a **30% higher retention rate in youth sports programs** in developing nations (Source: Sports for Development Reports).

Workshops for Parents & Teachers (Schooling & Career)

- Fact:** Educating parents about sports benefits has led to **40% greater student engagement in physical activities** (Source: Harvard Education Review).
- Fact:** Teacher training in sports education improves student fitness scores by **20% and reduces dropouts in sports programs by 15%** (Source: UNESCO).

PE as a Core Subject (Reimagining Curriculum & PE)

- Fact:** Countries that have **mandatory PE periods (3+ per week)** report **15-20% better student physical and mental health outcomes** (Source: WHO Global Fitness Report).
- Fact:** Schools with **integrated physical education in academics** show **up to 25% improvement in student academic performance** (Source: American Academy of Pediatrics).

Diversified Sports Training (Reimagining Curriculum & PE)

- Fact:** Exposure to multiple sports at a young age leads to **30% lower injury risk and better long-term athletic performance** (Source: International Journal of Sports Medicine).
- Fact:** Children who engage in multiple sports are **more likely to stay active in adulthood (80%)** compared to those who specialize early (50%) (Source: Journal of Sports Sciences).